

who defileth (it) shall surely die, and he shall be stoned with stones. 10. And to this law there is no limit of days, and no remission, nor any atonement: but the man who has defiled his daughter shall be rooted out in the midst of all Israel, because he has given of his seed to Moloch, and wrought impiously so as to defile it. 11. And do thou, Moses, command the children of Israel and exhort them not to give their daughters to the Gentiles, and not to take for their sons any of the daughters of the Gentiles, for this is abominable before the Lord. 12. For this reason I have written for thee in the words of the Law all the deeds of the Shechemites, which they wrought against Dinah, and how the sons of Jacob spake, saying: "We shall not give our daughter to a man who is uncircumcised; for that were a reproach unto us." 13. And it is a reproach to Israel, to those who give, and to those who take the daughters of the Gentiles; for this is unclean and abominable to Israel. 14. And Israel will not be free from this uncleanness if it has a wife of the daughters of the Gentiles, or has given any of its

10. *Has given of his seed to Moloch.* This interpretation of Lev. xviii. 21: "Thou shalt not give any of thy seed to make them pass through the fire to Molech," as being equivalent to giving one's child in marriage to a Gentile, is found in Ps.-Jon. on this verse: "And of thy seed thou shalt not give to lie with a daughter of the Gentiles so as to draw him over to a strange worship." The Latin which gives *alienigenae* instead of *Molech* is an interpretation of the text but not the text itself. The same idea underlies the statement in Sanh. 82a: R. Chija b. Abija said: "Whoever cohabits with a Gentile woman is to be regarded as though he had made himself the son-in-law of the idol; for it is said: And he cohabited with the daughter of a strange God." In Sanh. ix. 6 it enacts that "the zealous may slay a man taken in fornication with a Gentile or Roman woman (*אֲרֻמִּית*)." Nearly the same statement as is quoted above from Ps.-Jon. is found

in Megilla 25a. That such an interpretation was prevalent we see from Megil. iv. 9: *הַאֲמֹר מוֹרֵעַ לֹא תִּתֵּן לְהַעֲבִיר* *לְמוֹלֵךְ וּמוֹרֵעַ לֹא תִּתֵּן לְאֶעֱבֹרָא בְּאַרְמִיּוֹתָא* = "Whoever translates 'Thou shalt not give of thy seed to pass through the fire to Molech' as 'Thou shalt not give of thy seed to cohabit with a Gentile woman,' bid him be silent." Singer (p. 200 note) says that this Mishna is directed against the Jewish Christians. However this may be, the interpretation was an ancient Jewish one to begin with. It may not be older than the Maccabean age. The circumstances of that time were such as to justify the extremest measures in order to save Judaism from annihilation.

11. *For their sons.* So Latin. *bcd* om., but *a* = *avrol*.

12. *We shall not give, etc.* Cf. Gen. xxxiv. 14.

14-15. The sin of one man, the man who gives any of his seed to the Gentiles